

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Stone Age chronological-climatic spine

PLEISTOCENE

HOLOCENE

Lower Palaeolithic	-> Middle Palaeolithic	-> Upper Palaeolithic	-> Mesolithic
handaxe/cleaver	flakes/prepared cores	blades/bone/art	microliths
mobile landscapes	flexible reduction	wider symbolism	diverse niches
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Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Stone is a behavioural archive

RAW-MATERIAL NODULE -> CORE REDUCTION -> FLAKE/BLADE -> TOOL USE -> DISCARD

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source distance   skill/planning   edge damage   activity area
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ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT -> BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Lithic systems compared

LOWER	MIDDLE	UPPER	MESOLITHIC
bifaces, cleavers	flake tools	blades, burins	geometric microliths
large cutting tools	prepared-core planning	bone/ornament growth	hafted composites
quartzite common	raw-material economy	symbolic evidence	bow/sickle/barb uses
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Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.			

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Indian site map: region, site, significance

NORTH-WEST: Soan valley -> river-terrace lithics and sequence debates

NORTH: Belan valley -> long prehistoric sequence toward food production

CENTRAL: Bhimbetka -> shelters/rock art | Adamgarh -> Mesolithic evidence

WEST: Bagor -> Mesolithic settlement, subsistence and domestication debate

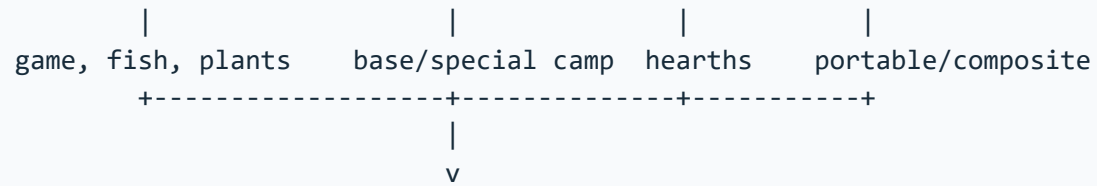
GANGA PLAIN: Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, Damdama -> burials and sedentism

SOUTH: Attirampakkam -> early Acheulian and Middle Palaeolithic chronology

DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal -> quarry, factory and landscape organisation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Mobility-subsistence-social loop

SEASONAL RESOURCES -> MOVEMENT SCHEDULE -> CAMP TYPE -> TOOL KIT -> SHARING NETWORK



Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.
Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Rock art and symbolic life: inference ladder

PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT

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secure: image, technique, relative sequence and demonstrated association

probable: hunting, dance, group action, animals and changing style

uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning

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VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Mesolithic transition: adaptation, not revolution

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES

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small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools

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seasonal mobility

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repeated/semi-sedentary camps

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selective plant/animal management -> uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Limits and current research

PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations

FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people | innovation = migration | burial = hierarchy

RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence

Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.

VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Stone Age answer architecture

10 MARKS: define phase -> diagnostic technology -> two sites -> subsistence -> caution

15 MARKS: chronology -> lithic comparison -> ecology/mobility -> symbolic evidence -> limits

20 MARKS: geological frame -> methods -> four-stage technology -> regional site map
-> economy/social life -> Mesolithic transition -> historiographical verdict

MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.

CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.
2. Adamgarh (MP) and Bagor (Rajasthan) provide early evidence for...
3. Bhimbetka is a key rock-art and prehistoric occupation site.

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. B-04 Domestication and Sambhar claims with caution Cards 13, 17 and 21
2. A-06 Rock art and cult evidence with caution Cards 14 and 19
3. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Practice contract Every solved item has demand decoding, an examiner-...
 2. [Interpretation] Dating, regionality, continuity, debates and UPSC...
 3. METHOD: Facts from sources are labelled FACT; analytical synthesis is...
- VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...